Paid Arguments in Favor

Cut the Red Tape. Deliver Services Faster.

San Francisco spends more than $5 billion a year on contracts — for everything from homeless services to street repairs — under purchasing rules scattered across more than 100 sections of city code, requiring 8.5 months to 1.5 years to complete a single contract. Small businesses and nonprofits, especially minority- and women-owned firms, are hit hardest.

This measure implements the recommendations of SPUR's 2025 Purchasing Power report and 2026 Charter for Change — research built on SPUR's century-long commitment to making San Francisco government work efficiently for the people it serves.

The measure puts one official, the City Administrator, in charge of proposing purchasing rule changes, subject to Board rejection within 60 days. It brings departments like the PUC and SFMTA under consistent citywide purchasing oversight. And it updates Board-approval contract thresholds, unchanged since 1996, to reflect nearly three decades of inflation.

Existing protections for minority- and women-owned business participation and labor standards on city contracts are untouched, as is the Board's budget authority over the City Administrator's office and the Mayor's ability to remove the City Administrator.

The result: faster contracting, lower administrative costs, and a system that's finally navigable for the nonprofits and small businesses serving San Francisco's most vulnerable residents.

Vote YES.

Sean Elsbernd
President/CEO SPUR (www.spur.org)

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: SPUR.

GOOD GOVERNANCE LEADERS AGREE PROP E WILL STOP THE WASTE IN PURCHASING.

We've spent our careers inside City Hall, and we've seen firsthand how a lack of transparent contracting rules allows waste and corruption to thrive. It can cost more than $25,000 just to run a single contracting process, and basic purchases can take years to deliver. Government doesn't have to be this slow, and it shouldn't reward insiders over results.

Prop E fixes the structure, not just the symptoms. It empowers a professional City Administrator to set clear, transparent standards, and it keeps real checks in place: the mayor or a board majority can reject proposed contracting changes within 60 days. We've watched San Franciscans lose faith in City Hall's ability to manage public dollars responsibly. Prop E is a real, structural step toward earning that trust back. Vote Yes on Prop E for stronger accountability and better city services.

Former Controller Ben Rosenfield
Former Sheriff Vicki Hennessy
Former Director of SF Planning John Rahaim
Former Deputy City Attorney James Lazarus
Former Fire Chief Joanne Hayes-White

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The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. Michael Moritz, 2. John Pritzker, 3. Chris Larsen.

LABOR GROUPS UNITE TO SUPPORT CONTRACTING REFORM IN PROP E.

Working people build this city and too often, the City's broken contracting system gets in our way. It costs too much, and basic purchases can take years. That's not a system that respects the workers who depend on City projects for our livelihoods. The current system opens the door to waste and abuse at every level, and working people pay the price when public dollars are lost to grift instead of going toward good jobs and real results.

Prop E brings real reform that's good for union contractors and workers who compete fairly and do the work right, and it's good for the public dollars that fund our jobs. Labor knows the difference between a system that works for working people and one that works for insiders. Prop E moves San Francisco in the right direction. Vote Yes on Prop E for accountability, fairness, and a city that works for everyone who builds it.

Firefighters 798
SF Building Trades
Teamsters Local 665
SEIU Local 87
*Carpenters Local 22 Senior Field Representative Dan Calamuci**
*Operating Engineers Local 3 District Representative Charles Lavery**
*Laborers Local 261 SF Liaison Anthony Travis Jr.**

*For identification purposes only; author is signing as an individual and not on behalf of an organization.

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Clean Up City Hall, Mayor Lurie's Ballot Measure Committee.

Arguments are the opinions of the authors and have not been checked for accuracy by any official agency.
Arguments are printed as submitted. Spelling and grammatical errors have not been corrected.

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SMALL AND BIG BUSINESSES URGE PURCHASING REFORM THROUGH PROP E.

San Francisco's businesses know what it's like to deal with the City's contracting system: slow, confusing, and often stacked against anyone who isn't already an insider. It's bad for the businesses trying to work with the City, and it's bad for taxpayers footing the bill. This broken system wastes money and is exploited, and businesses that play by the rules shouldn't have to compete with insiders who don't.

Prop E fixes this by empowering a professional City Administrator to set transparent standards so contracts are awarded based on merit and qualifications, not connections. That means a fairer playing field for the small businesses, contractors, and vendors who do honest work for the City every day. A more transparent, efficient contracting system means faster delivery of the projects and services San Francisco's economy depends on.

San Francisco's business community is united: Vote Yes on Prop E for accountability, fairness, and better city services.

Council of District Merchants Associations
SF Chamber of Commerce
Noe Valley Merchants and Professionals Association
Hotel Council

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CHINATOWN LEADERS SAY YES TO BETTER PURCHASING WITH PROP E.

Chinatown and immigrant communities across San Francisco know what it's like to be shut out of a system built for insiders. When billions of dollars for city contracts are handed out every year through inconsistent, confusing processes, the businesses and nonprofits working hardest to serve our community often lose out to whoever has the right connections downtown.

Prop E fixes the system at its root. It empowers a professional City Administrator to set clear, transparent standards so contracts go to whoever is best for the job, not whoever is best connected. That's a fairer chance for community organizations and small businesses that have always played by the rules. Chinatown deserves a City Hall that works as hard for our community as we work for this city. Vote Yes on Prop E for accountability and better city services.

Chinatown History and Culture Association
*Eva Lee, SF Chinatown Merchants Association**

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No Paid Arguments Against Proposition E Were Submitted